

CONTRACT OWNERSHIP

WEEK 2, DAY 4

What callers are allowed to depend on, what you are free to change, and how to know the difference in under a second.



THE CONTRACT IS FOUR THINGS

EVERYTHING ELSE IS YOURS TO CHANGE

1	The paths	<code>/firms /firms/{id} /firms/{id}/benchmarks</code>
2	The methods	<code>GET POST PUT DELETE</code>
3	The status codes	<code>200 201 204 404 422</code>
4	The response shape	<code>id, name, jurisdiction, revenue_usd_m...</code>

YOU PROVED THIS YESTERDAY

THE ROUTER SPLIT CHANGED EVERYTHING, AND NOTHING

IMPLEMENTATION — YOU CHANGED ALL OF THIS

- Which file each endpoint lives in
- One flat module became three
- Repeated lookups became a dependency
- add_firm gained a header and a dict

CONTRACT — NONE OF THIS MOVED

- GET /firms still returns the same list
- 404 still means the firm is not there
- POST still answers 201, DELETE still 204
- Every field still has the same name

Rewrite anything behind the contract and nobody calling it needs to know.

BREAKING, OR NOT?

ASK WHAT AN EXISTING CALLER WOULD DO

The change	Breaking?	Why
Rename revenue_usd_m	Yes	Every caller reading that field stops working
Add an optional field to a response	No	Old callers ignore fields they do not know
Add a required field to a request	Yes	Old callers do not send it, and now get a 422
Change POST from 201 to 200	Yes	Anything branching on the status now takes the wrong branch
Move endpoints into a router file	No	Nothing a caller can see has moved at all

YOU HAVE BEEN DOING THIS BY HAND

EVERY GUIDE THIS WEEK, THE SAME INSTRUCTION

THE LINE YOU HAVE READ TWENTY TIMES

"Re-run everything from yesterday to prove nothing broke."

THE PROBLEM WITH DOING IT BY HAND

- It only runs when you remember to run it
- Four curl commands takes a minute. Forty takes ten
- You check what you thought to check, not everything
- Under deadline pressure, it is the first thing skipped

MAKE THE CHECK COST NOTHING

WHAT YOU BUILD IN THE NEXT FIFTY MINUTES

- 1 Every curl becomes a test** Same checks, written once, run for ever
- 2 No server, no port** TestClient calls your app in-process, directly
- 3 Then break it on purpose** Change 201 to 200 and watch the suite catch you

Seven checks. Nought point three seconds. No memory required.